Huajie (Jay) Cao

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Education

Michigan State University — East Lansing*(MI)*, USA
Ph.D. Student in Media & Information, Advisor: Hee Rin Lee — 08/2023–Current

Renmin University of China — Beijing, China
M.S. in Communication — 09/2021–06/2023

Renmin University of China — Beijing, China
B.S. in Journalism; B.S. in Law — 09/2017–06/2021

Awards

Google PhD Fellowship Nominee, Michigan State University	2026
Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, ACM CHI	2026
Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, ACM CHI	2025
Best Paper Honorable Mention Award, ACM/IEEE HRI	2024

Publications

[8] Why Don't People Follow Robot Leaders? Understanding the Effects of Power Legitimacy on Compliance with Agents

H. Cao, M. Chen, H. R. Lee, and W. Peng, *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems 2026* (ACM CHI '26)

Best Paper Honorable Mention (Top 5%).

[7] Robot-Assisted Medical Training for Safety-Critical Environments

H. Cao, M. J. Sack, L. Mkrtchyan, K. Ching, T. Iqbal, H. R. Lee, and A. Taylor, *Proceedings of the 21st ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction* (ACM/IEEE HRI '26).

[6] Empowering Adults with AI Literacy: Using Short Videos to Transform Understanding and Harness Fear for Critical Thinking

H. Cao, H. R. Lee, and W. Peng, *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems 2025* (ACM CHI '25)

Best Paper Honorable Mention (Top 5%).

[5] AI literacy for Underserved Students: Exploring An Asset-Based Approach to Library-Based AI Literacy Program

H. Cao, K. Choi, C. Park, and H. R. Lee, *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems 2025* (ACM CHI '25).

[4] Towards Collaborative Crash Cart Robots that Support Clinical Teamwork

A. Taylor, T. Tanjim, **H. Cao**, and H. R. Lee, *Proceedings of the 2024 ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction* (ACM/IEEE HRI '24)

Best Paper Honorable Mention (Top 5%).

[3] Exploring Social Presence in Long-Distance Family Communication with Telepresence Robots in the Wild

J. A. Seo, H. Cho, **H. Cao**, and H. R. Lee, *2025 34th IEEE International Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN)*.

[2] Human-Robot Teaming Field Deployments: A Comparison Between Verbal and Non-verbal Communication

T. Tanjim, P. Ekpo, **H. Cao**, J. S. George, K. Ching, H. R. Lee, and A. Taylor, *2025 34th IEEE International Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (RO-MAN)*.

[1] Sociable robots or focused speakers? Transforming customer experience with communication style and embodiment type in smart home devices adoption

J. Shi, C. Lin, H. C. Wang, S. Jung, N. Ta, R. H. Liu, and **H. Cao**, *Behaviour & Information Technology*.

Manuscripts Under Review

[3] In Humans We Trust: Perceived Human Control Accounts for Trust in Human–AI Decision-Making

H. Cao, CHI 2027, under review.

[2] AI as an organizational ratchet: Understanding AI adoption across individual, interpersonal and organizational level

H. Cao, Y. Wang, and H. R. Lee, CHI 2027, under review.

[1] Too Old to be a Robot? The Influence of Robot Age on Expectations and Trustworthiness Dynamics

H. Cao and H. R. Lee, ACM Transactions on Human-Robot Interaction, revise and resubmit.

Teaching

Instructor

[1] MI220: Methods for Understanding Users — 2026summer

Teaching Assistant

[4] MI220: Methods for Understanding Users (Prof. Amenda Cote) — 2026fall

[3] MI101: Understanding Media and Information (Prof. David Ewoldsen) — 2025spring

[2] MI350: Evaluating Human-Centered Technology (Prof. Hee Rin Lee) — 2025spring;2026spring

[1] MI484: Human Robot Interaction (Prof. Hee Rin Lee) — 2024fall,2025fall